Document Summary

The guide outlines the framework, timeline, submission deliverables, and judging mechanisms for the NASA Space Apps Challenge 2026 Bangladesh ("The Next Frontier"). The local hackathon runs from 13–14 November 2026 across nine regional hubs (Dhaka, Chattogram, Sylhet, Rajshahi, Khulna, Barishal, Rangpur, Mymensingh, Cumilla). Participation requires mandatory dual registration—on the Bangladesh local portal and the official NASA Space Apps Challenge site—for teams of 1 to 6 members. The evaluation pipeline consists of three sequential judging passes driven by three distinct video submissions.

Prescreening Deadline

- **1 October 2026 at 11:59 PM BST**.

Prescreening Qualification & Submission Requirements

To qualify for the local event during prescreening, teams must complete the Bangladesh pre-registration form and submit Video 1:

- **Deliverable**: A YouTube video link (240 seconds maximum) pasted into the Bangladesh Google Form.
- **Required Content**:
- Team name.
- Full names of all team members.
- Targeted problem and official challenge statement (derived from the 17 September challenge summaries).
- Proposed solution approach (**concept level only**; a completed build or working demo is not required at this stage).
- **Compliance Hard Rules**:
- **Duration**: Strictly 240 seconds (4 minutes) or under; videos exceeding 240 seconds are cut off without exception.

- **Under-18 Safeguard**: No recognizable names, voices, or faces of individuals under 18 years of age may appear in the video.
- **Attribution**: Third-party assets, templates, stock material, or AI-generated content must be explicitly declared and credited.

Prescreening Marking Criteria & Evaluation Structure

Prescreening operates as **Pass 1 (Mainstage Selection)** to select ~50 physical mainstage teams nationwide while maintaining virtual eligibility for remaining teams. Judges evaluate the concept-stage submission using the official master score sheet:

1. Core Headline Criteria (100 Points Total, 1–20 Anchor Scale Each)

- **Impact (1–20 pts)**: Significance of the target problem, scale of effect, and potential to produce measurable outcomes.
- **Creativity (1–20 pts)**: Originality of the concept, novel cross-disciplinary approaches, or unique spins on existing solutions.
- **Validity (1–20 pts)**: Scientific soundness, baseline technical feasibility, and practical logic.
- **Relevance (1–20 pts)**: Direct alignment of the conceptual proposal with the selected challenge summary.
- **Presentation (1–20 pts)**: Narrative structure, clarity, storytelling impact, visual/audio polish, and English proficiency.

2. Supplementary Criteria & Multipliers (Up to 18 Additional Points)

- **Teamwork (1–5 pts)**: Evidence of genuine collaboration across distinct team roles.
- **User Experience (1–5 pts)**: Conceptual usability and accessibility.
- **NASA Data Usage (1–5 pts)**: Degree to which NASA/partner open data forms the core foundation of the concept.
- **Operational Binary Checks (0 or 1 pt each)**:
- 2026 challenge category explicitly identified.
- Public repository/Drive link provided and accessible.

- Submission page fields filled.
- **Diversity Bonus (+5%)**: A 5% bonus is added to the total aggregate score for teams containing one or more women members.

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